

Make 1 Project: *Google Ngram Viewer*

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1. What Is Being Made?

This project generates a chart based on how often a phrase, a word, or a combination of words appear in a variety of books each year. The output is in the form of a line graph, showing trends of popular words over the years.

2. What Is The Project Made From? (Data)

The graphs are made from a vast amount of books to go through and find commonalities in themes, words, and phrases. The books recognized as being utilized are basic language learning books that were scanned and uploaded. There are more books that are used but not credited, and were most likely pirated.

3. Tools, Algorithms, or Systems

The project uses a character reader (OCR) which reads through the books it has access to, in order to notice patterns in the writings. The books selected and uploaded to be read were chosen by humans; the only thing truly automated is the reading, since the separation of word forms with tags written by humans.

4. Human Labor & Decisions

Humans scanned and uploaded the books into the system, along with having programmed the tags in to find. The device creates the graphs, but humans gave the parameters, and books for it to make the graphs.

5. Design as Argument

The site generates one graph at a time and it refreshes quickly when you change the search doesn't show which books it took so it seems like it just knows the percentages, keeping the how a secret.

Reflection

With this project, "making" isn't making up an image or a set of fake words in a conversation, but about reviewing information it was given to it by humans and then creating a chart based on

what words, person, or phrase a person wants to find being written about commonly. The machine itself doesn't participate in the making of much outside of the chart by reading everything it was fed, and using that data to make a line graph, based on how common it was found in the books it was given throughout the years. The sources used for the project apart from the basic language books, were not given and most likely stolen to be used for the project to have access to more of the data. The charts are useful in discovering when a person was most popular, or infamous, by basing it off when the most about them was written, and released. It also shows when places, and topics, were being discussed the most. Human choices still impact how it works, determining what you want the graph to show and over what period of time people wrote about, people, places, and topics. Along with the tags made for the project to determine whether, the term they find is, a verb, adjective, noun or another form. All that the project itself makes is an easier way to determine when the data was discussed which can be helpful in locating when you want the information on what you searched to be from.